

Git Workflow Guide

PSID Project

Sarah Sullivan

Created: March 25, 2026

Last Updated: March 25, 2026

Made with: GitHub Copilot / Claude Sonnet 4.6

This file summarizes the command line statements to push a commit to GitHub.

Contents

I. Workflow	1
1) Everyday: push VS Code to GitHub	1
2) Collaborating: push GitHub changes to VS Code	2
II. Set Up	2
1) Login	2
2) Navigate to repo folder	2
3) Initialize	2
4) Edit .gitignore	2
5) Stage and commit	2
6) Connect to remote (first time only)	2
7) Push to GitHub	2
III. Troubleshooting	3
1) If push is rejected (histories don't match)	3
2) Lock file error	3
3) Unstage a file	3
4) Check status / history / remotes	3

I. Workflow

1) Everyday: push VS Code to GitHub

```
git pull                # get latest changes
git add .               # stage changes
git commit -m "comment changes"
git push                # upload to GitHub
```

2) Collaborating: push GitHub changes to VS Code

```
git pull origin main
git pull
```

II. Set Up

1) Login

```
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
git config --global user.email "sbsullivan19@gmail.com"
```

2) Navigate to repo folder

```
cd "/Users/sarsul/Library/CloudStorage/Dropbox -
UniversityofMichigan/Sarah Sullivan/SARAH-SOFT/research/psid"
```

3) Initialize

```
git init
git branch -M main
```

4) Edit .gitignore

Open .gitignore and edit to exclude files and folders from the repository. Currently, I am only uploading .do files to the repository.

5) Stage and commit

```
git add .
git status          # check what will be committed
git commit -m "COMMIT MESSAGE"
```

6) Connect to remote (first time only)

```
git remote add origin https://github.com/sarahs-house/psid.git
```

Check it worked:

```
git remote -v
```

7) Push to GitHub

```
git push -u origin main
```

After the first push, you can just use:

```
git push
```

III. Troubleshooting

1) If push is rejected (histories don't match)

```
git fetch origin  
git rebase origin/main
```

Or if you need to force-merge unrelated histories:

```
git pull origin main --allow-unrelated-histories  
git push -u origin main
```

2) Lock file error

```
fatal: Unable to create '.git/index.lock': File exists.
```

Fix:

```
rm -f .git/index.lock
```

3) Unstage a file

```
git restore --staged filename.do
```

4) Check status / history / remotes

```
git status  
git log --oneline  
git remote -v
```

12) See what changed

```
git diff
```